

After I gave Claude my prompt, it provided me with three options:

1. Static HTML/CSS/JS on GitHub Pages
2. React (Vite) or Next.js (static export) on Vercel/Netlify
3. Next.js (App Router) with API routes and a live-hosted demo backend

Out of these three, I chose the second option because it provides a balance between technical capability, maintainability, and the visual quality I need. My portfolio needs to represent my projects through descriptions, images, diagrams, links, and potentially embedded demos rather than complex functionality. React's component structure also allows me to organise my pages consistently, creating a more polished interface than Option 1.

I dropped Option 1 because I felt it would not showcase my technical ability and projects as effectively. Although it is the simplest and lowest-maintenance option, it would still meet my basic requirements. However, React allows me to reuse components, which makes the website more consistent and makes future changes simpler.

Option 3 would provide the most functionality and would be the most technically powerful option. However, it would require additional maintenance, and relying on free services introduces limitations such as quotas, cold starts, and potential availability issues. Since my portfolio does not currently require a backend, I felt this additional complexity and risk was unnecessary.

Can I maintain this? Yes. React, Vite, and Tailwind are technologies I have worked with before and match my current skill level. The portfolio will therefore be relatively easy for me to maintain without needing to manage a backend or server. It also gives me the flexibility to add more advanced functionality later if needed, while keeping the initial version mostly static.

Option 2 will also allow me to showcase my work in the way I want recruiters to see it, including project descriptions, visuals, diagrams, code repositories, and potentially embedded demonstrations.

In conclusion, I believe Option 2 works best because it is free, feasible within the two-week period, appropriate for my current skill level, and provides enough technical flexibility without introducing unnecessary maintenance.